

Key Insights & Business Recommendations : Global Superstore Analysis

Key Insights

1. Overall Sales & Profit

- The business made 12.64M in total sales and 1.47M in total profit, selling a total of 178.312K.
- The profit margin stayed steady at around 11.61% over the four years.

2. Technology Leads in Sales

- Technology brought in the most sales at 37.53%, followed by Furniture at 32.52% and Office Supplies at 29.96%.
- Even though Furniture sells a lot, it makes much less profit because of high costs and heavy discounts.

3. Regional Differences

- Some regions with high sales (like Central, South, and North) do not always make the highest profits.

4. Top-Selling Products

- A small group of popular items – such as Apple, Cisco, Motorola, and Nokia smartphones, along with the Canon copy machine – drive most of the top sales.
- On the other hand, items like Tables lose many because of deep discounts (over 20%) and high shipping costs.

5. Sales Over Time

- Monthly tracking from 2011 to 2014 shows that sales always go up at the end of the year (around November and December) and slow down yearly in the year (like February).

Business Recommendations

1. Control Discounts

- Set a rule to review any discounts higher than 20%, especially for heavy, low-profit items like Tables.

2. Focus on Profitable Categories

- Keep promoting Technology since it makes good money, and find a way to lower costs or raise prices for Furniture.

3. Check Regional Performance

- Look closely at the regions that have high sales but low profits to check if shipping costs or high discounts are causing the issue.

4. Improve Customer Sales Strategy

- Do not judge customers only by how much money they spend. Fix pricing terms for big buyers who currently cause the company to lose money.

5. Plan Ahead for Busy Seasons

- Use the end-of-year sales pattern (from 2011 - 2014) to make sure you have enough stock for popular items like smartphones and copiers before the holiday rush.

Conclusion

This project shows how SQL, Python and dashboards work together to turn raw sales data into clear business advice. By looking at profits, discounts, and shipping costs instead of just total sales, the business can grow in a smarter, more profitable way.